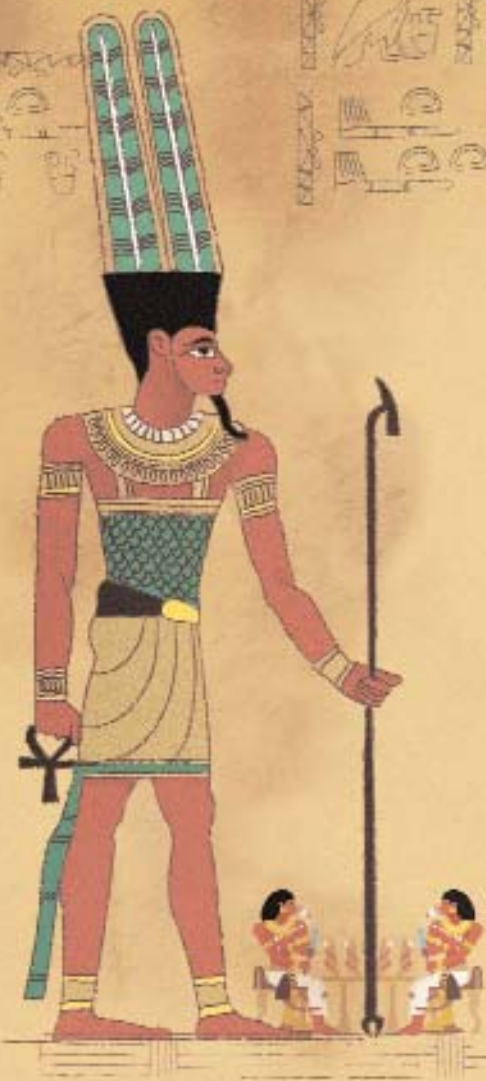




Linux Distribution

Suse Linux 9.1 Professional

Our Verdict: While most Linux pros will swear by Redhat Linux, SuSE Linux 9.1 professional has its own way of enticing novice and seasoned pros alike. Right from the installation to the customisation phase, SuSE Linux has something extra to get your attention. The installation is simple and the graphic interface makes it easy for beginners. The packages in the 5-CD set are

extensive enough to cover demands of programmers, administrators and casual users. Updates can be configured to be downloaded regularly. We recommend SuSE 9.1 Pro to users who are not confident of using classic and traditional Linux flavours.

Runner-up:

RedHat Enterprise Linux Professional WS



OCR

ABBYY FineReader Professional 7.0

Our Verdict: ABBYY Software's FineReader 7.0 Professional Edition raises the bar on Optical character recognition solutions. This newer version comes with product activation and requires you to have Internet connection for completing the activation process, failing which, it will run in a stripped down mode. The interface is sim-

ple, the software compatible with most TWAIN devices. Accuracy of the new version is as good as the old one and is now faster. Features like direct scanning of documents into MS Word 2003, MS PowerPoint, etc, makes this software fascinating to work with.

Runner-up: OmniPage Pro 14 Office



Office Suites

Microsoft Office 2003

Our Verdict: With the latest release of its Office suite, Microsoft has improved Front-Page and Outlook a great deal. With the addition of OneNote (a note taking application), the improvements hold a lot of promise, especially for corporate users. Support for XML means document sharing and porting is a lot easier, and the suite's application

programming capabilities are much better. However, the rest of the applications in the Office suite—Word, Excel and PowerPoint—have minimal improvements. We don't see significant improvements with this release, though. Office 2003 is still a cut above the other players.

Runner-up: OpenOffice.org 1.1.3



PVR Software

PowerVCR II Standard Edition

Our Verdict: Armed with top-of-the-line features such as time-shifting and instant replay, PowerVCR II makes TV-viewing enjoyable. With the time-shifting feature, you need not wait for a commercial to answer nature's call. Use the 'Instant Replay' button to watch the fall of wickets in a cricket match. PowerVCR II is very user-friendly—a small window pops up

after its installation to help you set up the channels. It provides pre-defined profiles — MPEG-2 Excellent, MPEG-2 Superior, MPEG-2 Good and MPEG-2 Average—to capture video. It can convert the captured video from, or to, any of these formats, without the need for a third-party converter.

Runner-up: Intervideo Win DVR



Productivity Suite

Evolution: Microsoft's Office remains the most used and liked office productivity tool for professionals and casual users. Excellent features, an impeccable interface, blinding legacy and no competition, lends Microsoft's Office 2003 the gold medal.

Linux

Evolution: Back in 2000, Linux OSes were the play tools of curious, knowledge hungry geeks. However, to

survive in this Wintel world, evolution was the only way out and look what a leap they have taken in four years! Four years ago, Linux was notoriously known for hardware incompatibility and driver issues but today, the community effort has done away with such issues.

SuSE Linux's commitment to provide the best in Linux got them the Zero-one award in 2000 and this trend continues today. Their commitment is consistent and truly commendable!

